MIL-C-44088(GL)
21 September 1982
SUPERSEDING
(See 6.4)

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CELERY, DEHYDRATED

This specification is approved for use by the US Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers dehydrated celery for use by the Armed Forces as a component of operational rations.

1.2 Classification. The celery shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1).

1. Type I - Glycerol-treated
2. Type II - Gum-treated

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-C-29	-	Canned Subsistence Items, Packaging and Packing of
PPP-C-96	-	Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-L-1497	-	Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8915

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MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items; General Specification For

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

FEDERAL

FED-STD-101 - Preservation, Packaging and Packing Materials: Test Procedures

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

OTHER GOVERNMENT DOCUMENTS

US DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

US Standards for Celery

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Information Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, US Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

US Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Food Quality Assurance Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

US DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act (21 CFR, Parts 1 to 199) and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for issuance thereof.)

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2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

NATIONAL RESEARCH COUNCIL

Food Chemicals Codex (F.C.C.)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of the Director, National Academy of Sciences, National Research Council, 2101 Constitution Avenue, Washington, DC 20408.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N. W., Washington, DC 20036.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Bid sample. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1) four cans with a net weight of at least 4 ounces each, representative of the product which the bidder proposed to furnish and which have been nitrogen gas packaged or packaged under a vacuum of not less than 27 inches of mercury and comply with the document requirements, shall

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be submitted to the contracting officer prior to the bid opening. One of the samples shall be evaluated by a technical group at the US Army Natick R&D Labs to determine compliance with 3.5.2 for the subjective characteristics (flavor, odor, color, and texture). In addition, technical group shall rate the samples as to overall quality, taking into consideration all the subjective characteristics. The remaining samples shall be held at 40°F or lower until used as a standard for the subjective characteristics in determining acceptance of intended delivery products. The approval of any bid sample for the aforementioned characteristics shall not constitute approval of the product as meeting the other requirements of this document.

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Celery. The product shall be prepared from the stalk of good quality Pascal celery meeting the requirements of U.S. No. 1 Grade. The celery shall be clean and sound.

3.2.2 Sodium sulfite or sodium bisulfite. The sulfite(s) used shall meet the requirements of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.3 Glycerol. Glycerol used shall meet the requirements of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.4 Locust bean gum. Locust bean gum used shall meet the requirements of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.3 Preparation.

3.3.1 Washing and sorting. The stalks shall be separated and washed to remove sand, soil, and foreign material. The washed celery shall be sorted and trimmed to remove leaves, butt end material and material affected by decay, freezing, insect injury, discoloration, disease, or other physical damage.

3.3.2 Cutting. Prior to sulfiting and dehydrating, the celery shall be cut into nominal 5/8 inch cross sectional slices which will meet the sieve requirement of 3.5.1. A piece less than 3/8 inch long shall be considered a broken unit.

3.4 Processing.

3.4.1 Soaking.

3.4.1.1 Type I - Glycerol-treated. The type I celery shall be soaked in a 30 to 50 percent water solution of glycerol for not less than 3 hours.

3.4.1.2 Type II - Gum-treated. The type II celery shall be soaked in a water solution containing 1 percent locust bean gum for not less than 3 hours.

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3.4.2 Draining. Both type I and type II soaked celery shall be thoroughly drained, prior to sulfiting and dehydration.

3.4.3 Sulfiting. The celery shall receive a sulfite treatment by such method as will insure uniform distribution throughout the product and a residual sulfur dioxide content in the dehydrated product, within the limitations specified in 3.5.1.

3.4.4 Dehydration. Dehydration shall be by such method that the product shall not be scorched or otherwise damaged by heat or drying and shall meet the requirements specified in 3.5.

3.5 Finished product requirements.

3.5.1 Dehydrated product. The product shall possess a bright, light green to green color and a good typical aroma, free from haylike, scorched, musty or other objectionable odors. The moisture content shall not exceed 4.5 percent. The sulfur dioxide content of the product shall be 750 $\pm$ 250 ppm. The product shall consist primarily of unbroken cross sections of the celery stalk with no more than 5 percent by weight of pieces which pass through a U.S. Standard 3/8 inch sieve, and shall be practically free of defective, scorched, burned or off-color pieces. The product and container shall be free from insect infestation and foreign material such as splinters, paint, varnish, rubber, metals, etc.

3.5.2 Rehydrated product. The product shall rehydrate to approximately its original cut form and to a texture similar to fresh celery when 2.0 ounces of type I or 1.5 ounces of type II celery are added to 16 fluid ounces of cold water in a vessel, covered and allowed to stand for 3 hours with two changes of water at the same level at hourly intervals. The product shall possess a color, odor, flavor appearance and texture similar to fresh celery and shall be free from objectionable flavors or odors.

3.5.3 Palatability. The product shall be comparable to the approved bid sample in color, odor, flavor, texture and appearance.

3.6 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed and packaged under sanitary conditions in accordance with good manufacturing practice. The product shall be processed in establishments meeting the sanitary requirements of the applicable government inspection agency.

3.7 Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and acceptance service. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of acceptance service necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document. The cost of grading and acceptance services performed by the USDA involving inspection, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

4.3 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection. Components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.3.1.1 Ingredient examination. Conformance of ingredients to identity and condition requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, invoices, certificates of analysis, or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient lot or of any involved product.

4.3.1.2 Testing of cans. Cans shall be tested for tin plate in accordance with any method specified in PPP-C-96. The sample unit shall be one can with lid. The sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-1. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of cans. Test requirement and reporting of results for tin plate shall be as specified in PPP-C-96. Testing of can label and external can coating (when required) shall be performed on the same cans submitted for tin plate test with additional cans as required to complete the sample plan of TT-C-495. A test failure shall indicate unacceptable cans and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the involved end item.

4.3.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the ingredient preparation, product processing, and sealing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation; certificates of conformance; or other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

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4.3.3 End item examination. Examination shall be in accordance with tables II and III and 4.3.3.1 through 4.3.3.6. The sampling plans and acceptable quality levels (AQLs), expressed as percent defective for defects applicable to table II and as defects per hundred units for defects applicable to table III shall be as shown in table I.

TABLE I. Sampling plans and AQLs

Table	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	Inspection level	AQLs	
				Major	Minor
II	One filled can	Cans	S-2	-	2.5
III	One filled can	Cans	S-2	1.5	-

TABLE II. Examination for net weight 1/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Net weight more than 5 percent under specified net weight. 2/

1/ Lot shall be rejected if sample data indicate lot average net weight is less than specified net weight.

2/ Report results to nearest 0.1 ounce.

TABLE III. Examination of product characteristics 1/

Category	Defect
Major	Dehydrated product
101	Not comparable to the approved bid sample in color and odor.
102	More than 1 percent, by weight, of heat damaged pieces butt ends or leaves. 2/
103	More than 1 percent, by weight, of pieces damaged by pathological or insect injury or more than 3 percent by weight, of spotted or blemished pieces. 2/
104	More than 10 percent, by weight, of broken pieces. 2/ 3/

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TABLE III. Examination of product characteristics 1/ (cont'd)

Category	Defect
Major	Dehydrated product (cont'd)
105	More than 5 percent, by weight, of pieces passing through a U.S. Standard 3/8 inch sieve (see 4.4.3).
106	Color not fairly bright green. 6/
107	Haylike, scorched, rancid, musty or other objectionable odor.
	Rehydrated product 4/ 5/
108	Color, odor, flavor, appearance, and texture not comparable to fresh celery stalks or approved bid sample as appropriate.
109	More than 3 percent by weight of completely rehydrated individual pieces.

1/ Presence of foreign material, e.g., metal, wood, sand, soil, glass, filth, insect or insect fragments, rubber, varnish, paint, rodent feces, or harmful extraneous material, shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Examine 4 ounces from a can.

3/ A piece less than 3/8 inch long shall be considered a broken piece. The broken piece shall be separated from the sample, and percentage of broken pieces determined on a weight basis.

4/ Determine once per sample unit.

5/ Prepare by adding 2.0 ounces of type I or 1.5 ounces of type II dehydrated product to 16.0 fluid ounces of cold water. Cover and allow to stand for 3 hours with 2 water changes at 1 hour intervals.

6/ Defect not applicable when bid sample is required as a reference standard.

4.3.3.1 Examination of cans. Examination of filled and sealed cans for external condition shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

4.3.3.2 Examination for leakage and vacuum. Examination for leakage and vacuum shall be in accordance with the applicable examination criteria of PPP-C-29.

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3.3.3 Examination of can coating. Examination of can coating shall be in ccordance with the examination criteria of TT-C-495.

4.3.3.4 Examination of can labeling. Examination of can labeling shall be in ccordance with the examination criteria of MIL-L-1497.

4.3.3.5 Examination of fiberboard shipping containers. When shipping containers re required to be in accordance with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in onstruction, closure, and reinforcement shall be in accordance with the appendix of PP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows: ajor: Natonal stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack arkings missing, incorrect, or illegible. Minor: (1) Other required markings issing, incorrect, or illegible; (2) Arrangement or number of cans not as pecified; (3) When applicable, reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is ot used. For level C containers, only the defects pertaining to marking, rrangement, number of cans, and for the closure method specified in 5.2.3 shall be pplicable.

4.3.3.6 Examination of unit loads. Unit loads shall be examined in accordance ith the pertinent examination criteria in MIL-L-35078 and the applicable pecification sheet for the type and class of load specified (see 5.3).

4.3.4 Finished product. The finished product shall be tested for moisture and ulfur dioxide content in accordance with the procedures described in 4.4.1 and .4.2. The sample for testing shall be 1-pound composite, derived from the number ans indicated by inspection level S-2. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of . Results for moisture shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent, and for ulfite to the nearest ppm. A test failure for either moisture or sulfur dioxide ontent shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4 Methods of inspection.

4.4.1 Moisture. Moisture determination shall be made by the vacuum-oven method s follows:

OTE: Samples for moisture determination shall be collected in clean, dry jars which shall be completely filled, sealed with airtight lids, and held until analyzed.

(a) Preparation of sample. Grind 100 grams of a well-mixed sample in a clean, dry, Waring blender or similar mill, for 1 minute. The blender bowl or the mill shall be prepared for use by first grinding a portion of the sample, which is then discarded. Place the ground material in a small, dry, tightly-closed container for at least one-half hour. Pass the ground material over a U.S. Standard No. 20 sieve. That portion which passes through the U.S. Standard No. 20 sieve is to be analyzed for moisture, and shall be weighed immediately or placed in a small, dry container with a tightly-closed lid until ready for analysis (a one-half pint Mason jar is satisfactory).

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(b) Procedure. Weigh accurately two 3.0 gram samples of the ground, screened material (that portion which has passed through the U.S. Standard No. 20 sieve) into tared, dry, aluminum weighing dishes (approximately 2 to 2.5 inches in diameter and 0.75 inch in depth) with tight-fitting covers. Place the dishes with cocked lids in a vacuum oven and dry for 6 hours at 70°C under a pressure of not more than 100 mm mercury. Remove the dishes and allow them to cool in a desiccator before weighing. Calculate the percent of moisture in the original samples.

4.4.2 Sulfur dioxide determination. Sulfur dioxide content of the sample ground as specified in 4.4.1 (a) but not sieved, shall be determined in accordance with Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, chapter: Food Additives: Direct, section: Chemical Preservatives, method: Total Sulfurous Acid, Modified Monier-Williams.

4.4.3 Screening. Screening examination shall be performed as follows: Weigh entire contents of can. Place approximately 3 ounces of dehydrated material on a U.S. Standard 3/8 inch sieve, tip back and forth through a 90-degree arc 25 times. Empty materials remaining on sieve into appropriate container and repeat this procedure until the entire contents of can have been screened. Weigh total material passing through sieve and calculate percentage.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A net weight of 1 pound of type I celery or 12 ounces of type II celery shall be unit packed into an open-top style, round metal can, size 401 by 411, with a soldered or welded side seam and compound-lined double-seamed ends. A net weight tolerance of minus 5 percent under the specified net weight is permitted provided the average net weight of product in cans in any lot is not less than the specified net weight when examined in accordance with table II. The can shall be made throughout from not less than 0.25 pound per base box electrolytic tin plate (see 4.3.1.2). The can shall have a sufficient base plate weight and temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I or when specified (see 6.1) type III of TT-C-495 (see 4.3.3.3). The filled can shall be hermetically sealed under an atmosphere of nitrogen so that oxygen content of the gases in the container does not exceed 2.0 percent when determined as specified in method 6011 of FED-STD-101 or by any USDA approved test methods. Alternatively, the filled can shall be sealed under a vacuum of not less than 27 inches of mercury and shall meet this requirement when examined in accordance with 4.3.3.2.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with or without commercial exterior coating will be acceptable. Alternatively, cans may be made from 0.20 pound per base box electrolytic tinplate or electrolytic chromium coated steel normally used for the product, provided the can is coated with a commercial exterior coating.

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5.2 Packing. Twenty-four cans of the product, arranged 4 in length, 3 in width, d 2 in depth shall be packed on end in a snug fitting shipping container in cordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. The shipping container shall be a fiberboard box, con-ructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, V2s of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B packing. The shipping container shall be a fiberboard box, con-ructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with style RSC, W5c or W5s of P-B-636.

5.2.2.1 Nonmetallic reinforcement of shipping container. When specified (see 6.1 d 6.3), the shipping container specified in 5.2.2 shall be reinforced with non-tallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape in cordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C packing. The shipping container shall be in accordance with the iform Freight Classification or the National Motor Freight Classification, as plicable. Slotted fiberboard boxes shall be closed in accordance with method II as ecified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1), the cans of the product, packed as ecified in 5.2, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for e type and class of load specified. For distribution to Navy, when unit loads are -pped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling and marking.

5.4.1 Cans. Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. In addition, beling shall include the following:

Directions for Use

(a) Type I

1. Soak contents for 3 hours in 1 gallon of cold water under refrigeration (34-40°F).
2. Change water after the first and second hour.
3. Drain celery and refrigerate in a closed container.
4. Net weight of dehydrated celery - 1 lb.
5. Approximate weight of rehydrated celery - 3.75 lbs.

(b) Type II

1. Soak contents for 3 hours in 1 gallon of cold water under refrigeration (34-40°F)
2. Change water after the first and second hour.
3. Drain celery and refrigerate in a closed container.
4. Net weight of dehydrated celery - 12 ounces.
5. Approximate weight of rehydrated celery - 3.3 lbs.

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5.4.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.3 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

(a) Type of product required (see 1.2).
(b) When a bid sample is required (see 3.1).
(c) Levels of preservation and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) When type III exterior coating of cans is adequate (see 5.1.1).
(e) When nonmetallic reinforcement is required for level packing (see 5.2.2.1 and 6.3).
(f) Type and class of unit load when unit loading is specified (see 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack (Military agencies). Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, storage, and handling of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/ AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 Selection of nonmetallic reinforcement. The nonmetallic reinforcement specified in 5.2.2.1 should be selected for shipping containers that are destined for transfer at sea or other specific overseas operations.

6.4 Supersession data. This document includes the requirements of LP/P. DES 21-77A - Celery, Dehydrated, dated 28 December 1977.

Custodian:

Army - GL

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8915-A644

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER *(Number)* AND TITLE

MIL-C-44088(GL) Celery, Dehydrated

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☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER

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